

SaaS Analyst Decision Framework

A practical framework for thinking through product, retention and customer-health problems

Step 1 — What decision are we supporting?

Leadership wants to know whether growth is healthy, where customers are leaving, how much recurring revenue is exposed, and which customers deserve intervention.

Step 2 — Separate growth from retention

MRR can grow while churn is also worsening. Therefore track new, expansion, contraction and churn effects rather than relying on total MRR alone.

Step 3 — Find concentration

Overall churn is only the starting point. Segment by plan, industry and acquisition channel to find whether risk is concentrated in specific groups.

Step 4 — Connect behavior to outcome

Compare product engagement and support experience for active versus churned accounts. The question is not 'what is the average usage?' but 'what behaviors distinguish customers who stay from customers who leave?'

Step 5 — Prioritize financially

Combine churn status with MRR. A small customer with high churn probability is not automatically more urgent than a large customer with similar risk.

Step 6 — Create a health signal

Use usage, support and satisfaction to create a transparent score. The score is a prioritization tool, not a machine-learning claim.

Step 7 — Recommend an action

Examples: onboarding intervention for low-engagement new customers; escalation monitoring for high-ticket customers; retention outreach for high-MRR accounts showing declining engagement.

Derived project conclusion

In this synthetic portfolio dataset, churn is a meaningful retention issue and a material recurring-revenue exposure. The most useful analytical move is to move from 'what is churn?' to 'where is churn concentrated, how much MRR is exposed, and which behavioral signals can help Customer Success prioritize intervention?'

Interview takeaway

Say: 'I analyzed the SaaS customer lifecycle across subscriptions, product usage and support data, quantified revenue at risk, segmented churn drivers, and translated the findings into customer-health priorities.'